diplomacy to please their domestic political supporters and raise the country's profile in the global South. In South Africa, China's expected support and investment in Africa's growth has topped the list. The non-China BRICS all see China as the most important member of the group, and tying China to their economic and club interests has been a critical element of the BRICS' collective financial statecraft.

Finally, Chapter 5 concludes the book by discussing the implications of the BRICS' collective financial statecraft and analyzing its prospects. Contrary to initial expectations, the BRICS have hung together by identifying common aversions and pursuing common interests within the existing international order. Their future depends not only on their bargaining power, but also on their ability to overcome domestic impediments to the sustainable economic growth that provides the basis for their international positions. To continue successfully with their collective financial statecraft, the members must tackle the "middle income trap," as well as their preferences for informal rules originating from their own institutional weaknesses or regime preferences. This book shows that, in the context of a global power shift, the BRICS club has operated to protect the member countries' respective policy autonomy while also advancing a joint voice in global governance. Recently, the BRICS have made concrete institutional gains, giving them expanded outside options to achieve specific objectives in global finance.